

Your business is talking to you. Do you know how to listen?

Case study — SME financial diagnostic

Sector : Construction

Region : Turnhout, Belgium

Fiscal years analysed : FY2023 – FY2025

CONFIDENTIAL

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THE FOUNDING STORY

700 000 € lost in the blind spot of a collaboration



700 000 € uncollected — 6 months



THE HERO

An accountant confronting an unexplained anomaly in a marketplace's data.



THE CHALLENGE

700 000 €

in real sales never collected. Over 6 months.
Without anyone noticing.



THE LESSON

The blind spot between teams costs more than any fraud.



THE CONTEXT

In my previous role, as e-commerce and marketplace accountant at a fashion company, we were integrating a new online sales platform. On the sales side: total enthusiasm. New channel, new sales, new revenue. On the finance side: the figures seemed to confirm the success. Sales were being recorded correctly.



THE DISCOVERY

But during my monthly reconciliations, something was off. The revenue was there on paper — the cash, however, never reached the bank. I dug deeper. Cross-checked the accounting data against the marketplace reports. Isolated the anomalies. And the verdict landed: 700 000 € of real sales had never been collected. Over 6 months.



THE BLIND SPOT

The cause? Not fraud. Not an error. Just a blind spot in the collaboration between teams. Sales drove the deals. IT handled the technical integration. Finance reconciled the entries. But no one held the end-to-end view of the flow — from the sale through to the actual cash landing in the bank. For that specific marketplace, payments were not automatic. They required a manual validation that no one had taken ownership of. In the excitement of the launch, this critical step had fallen through the cracks between teams.

In any company — large or small — actual cash is often the great forgotten metric of the dashboards. We steer revenue, we watch margins, we track costs. But the real cash lives in the blind spot between departments, between tools, between responsibilities.

For an SME, this blind spot can be fatal. Without a dedicated management controller, without a cross-functional view, the warning signals pile up in silence — until the day it is too late to act.

It is precisely to close this blind spot that GPS Fin Consulting was created.



No one held the end-to-end view of the flow — from the sale through to the actual cash in the bank.

— The blind spot that started it all

Why GPS Fin Consulting exists

11 063

SME bankruptcies in Belgium in 2024

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In 2024, cash flow severely tested thousands of Belgian SMEs. The construction sector ranks among the hardest hit.

— FPS Economy, January 2026 ¹



THE FINDING

Belgian SMEs have no dedicated management controller. The finance function is often limited to bookkeeping — not to steering cash flow.



THE BLIND SPOT

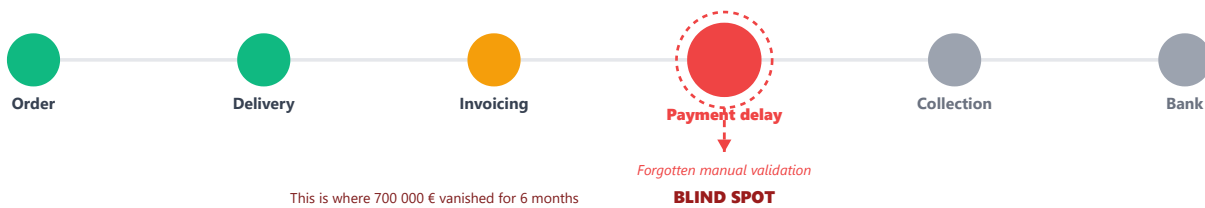
Actual cash lives between the tools, the teams and the responsibilities. Weak signals go unnoticed — until the critical moment.



THE RESPONSE

GPS Fin Consulting: a cross-functional view of the financial flow, a proprietary GPS Score™, a complete diagnostic delivered in 24 hours.

CASH CYCLE — FROM ORDER TO ACTUAL COLLECTION



The question is not whether your business has blind spots. The question is: have you detected them before they cost you?

→ Next page: the diagnostic under real conditions on a Belgian SME in the construction sector.

¹ FPS Economy — Annual trend in bankruptcies and job losses (2024). economie.fgov.be/fr/themes/entreprises/pme-et-independants-en/faillites-et-pertes-demplois/evolution-annuelle-et

The diagnostic under real conditions

Company Alpha

Sector Construction · Fiscal years FY2023 – FY2025



Data 100% sourced from the National Bank of Belgium — no manual entry required.



Anonymised data — all identifying information has been removed. GPS Fin Consulting never discloses client data without explicit consent.

A — EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

⚠ **HIGH RISK** — Financial health score : 10/100 — Estimated survival : 3,3 months

TOP 3 CRITICAL RISKS

- 1 EBITDA: -422 EUR
- 2 Equity declining YoY (67,158 EUR → 60,583 EUR) with net loss of -6,575 EUR
- 3 Zero liquidity buffer — a single shock triggers insolvency

TOP 3 IMMEDIATE ACTIONS

- 1 **Correct your prices immediately** — Increase all your prices by at least 20 %. Stop accepting projects below cost. Audit your 3 main contracts this week. *Impact: Reverse the operating loss in 60-90 days*
- 2 **Accelerate collections** — Send immediate reminders to all overdue clients. Require 30-50 % upfront deposit on every new contract starting now. *Impact: Free up EUR 10,853 within 30 days*
- 3 **Obtain an emergency credit line** — Contact your bank this week. Request a line of EUR 10-15 K. A single client default = insolvency. *Impact: Extend the survival horizon beyond 12 months*

B — LIQUIDITY RISK, ACTIONS & GPS SCORE™

GPS SCORE FRAMEWORK — GLOBAL PERFORMANCE SCORE

6.1
/ 10

High Risk

PROFITABILITY

1.0 / 10

ROA · EBITDA · Net result

LIQUIDITY

10.0 / 10

Current ratio · Cash ratio · Op. CF

SOLVENCY

10.0 / 10

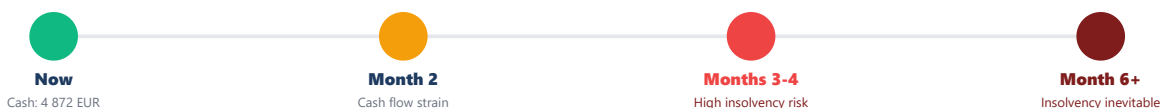
Equity ratio · D/E leverage

EFFICIENCY

2.0 / 10

Asset turnover · Receivables

LIQUIDITY RISK TIMELINE



✓ IMMEDIATE ACTIONS — NEXT 30 DAYS

1

Correct your prices immediately

Increase all your prices by at least 20 %. Stop accepting projects below cost. Audit your 3 main contracts this week.

Impact: Reverse the operating loss in 60-90 days

2

Accelerate collections

Send immediate reminders to all overdue clients. Require 30-50 % upfront deposit on every new contract starting now.

Impact: Free up EUR 10,853 within 30 days

3

Obtain an emergency credit line

Contact your bank this week. Request a line of EUR 10-15 K. A single client default = insolvency.

Impact: Extend the survival horizon beyond 12 months

REALISTIC SURVIVAL HORIZON

3,3 – 8,9 mois

Plan for the worst-case scenario

PESSIMISTIC SCENARIO

**3,3
mois**

30% receivables default + cost increase

CRITICAL

BASE SCENARIO

**8,9
mois**

If you change nothing

OPTIMISTIC SCENARIO

**17,3
mois**

With accelerated collection

These projections are calculated from your real financial data (NBB FY2025). They assume current trends persist without corrective action. →
Next page: how GPS Fin Consulting can help you.

Do you really know where your business stands?

THE GPS SCORE™ — 3 DIMENSIONS, ONE VISION

A single score out of 10, synthesising three fundamental dimensions of financial health. Each dimension is rated from 0 to 10.

G Growth Growth & revenue momentum — score / 10	P Profitability Profitability & operating margins — score / 10	S Sustainability Sustainability & balance-sheet strength — score / 10
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5 DELIVERABLES, ONE COMPLETE DIAGNOSTIC

	CEO Decision Report KPMG-style decision summary, ready for the management committee (PDF).
	Financial Diagnostic Report Complete analysis of financial statements and ratios over N fiscal years (PDF).
	Interactive Dashboard Exploratory dashboard with dynamic charts (HTML).
	Dashboard PDF Printable version of the dashboard for distribution and archiving.
	Excel Financial Model Auditable model, every ratio traceable back to source data.

Get your company's diagnostic in 24h

contact@gpsfinancial.be